[APPENDIX 4]

QUEST INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

QUEST INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY (QIU)
FACULTY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES
FINAL ASSESSMENT
JULY 2026

ASSIGNMENT COVER SHEET

Course Details

Subject Code	:	**BSN1083**
Course	:	**SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION**
Programme	:	**BACHELOR OF SPECIAL NEEDS EDUCATION**
Year & Semester	:	**202607**
Lecturer's Name	:	**Ms Amanda**

Assignment Details

Due Date	:	**22nd October 2026 (Thursday)**

Student's Details

Name & Matric No.	:	**CAROLINE FAM ZHI XIN (QIU-202507-008503)**

Assignment Overall Marks: _____ **Marks**

Table of Content

1.0 INTRODUCTION **3**

2.0 IDENTIFICATION AND ANALYSIS OF SOCIAL PROBLEMS, SOCIAL STRUCTURES AND EDUCATIONAL INEQUALITY **4**

2.1 Identification and Analysis of Social Problems **4**

2.2 Education and Wider Social Structures **5**

2.3 Digital Divide, Educational Inequality & Inclusive Education **6**

2.4 Proposed Interventions and Recommendations **9**

3.0 CONCLUSION **10**

DECLARATION OF AI USE **10**

REFERENCES **11**

1.0 Introduction

Sociology of Education is about how the society, family background and school rules affect students' learning and academic success in school. Instead of blaming a student's effort for low grades, this field looks at how the society shapes their learning opportunities. Therefore, digital inequality means that not everyone has the equal access to devices, good internet or digital skills. In modern schools, online learning has become the major way that teachers teach lessons and measure student's progress. When the schools start to force students to use the internet without checking if every family has a computer, then technology will become a barrier for low-income families and special needs students. Forcing online learning without providing support will creates severe learning barriers for B40 students (Lee & Ali, 2024).

A school in Malaysia named Sekolah Menengah Seri Harapan, started a rule that requires teachers to give at least two online activities for students each week. However, this rule affected poorer families. While the case study focuses on Aiman, which is a fourteen years old student with dyslexia and limited financial background. Aiman faces severe barriers, such as his family owns only one old smartphone with poor internet connection and his teachers give heavy text for him to read. The purpose of this report is to analyze the social problems created by digital inequality using sociology concepts.

2.0 Identification and Analysis of Social Problems, Social Structures and Educational Inequality

2.1 Identification and Analysis of Social Problems

The case study shows three major social problems that prevent students from receiving a fair education. The first social problem is unequal access to technology, which is the first level of digital divide. This first level happens when low income families cannot afford basic devices or suitable internet connections (van Deursen & van Dijk, 2021). This problem affects low-income students like Aiman and Siti. It is caused by financial limitations brought from low income, informal employment, which have no extra money to buy personal laptops, tablets or suitable internet connections. This issue shows how income gaps will turn basic learning technology into an access that only richer families can afford in today's society.

The second social problem is the usage of technology, which is the second level in the digital divide. According to van Deursen and van Dijk (2021), the second level happens when teachers fail to make digital lesson files accessible for students with learning difficulties. This problem affects diverse students with learning difficulties, such as Aiman who has dyslexia. The main cause is that the school does not require teachers to make the digital files accessible and fails to train teachers in inclusive classrooms. Therefore, teachers teach lessons through long text and heavy slides without providing audio or visual support. This issue connects to society by assuming all the students read and process information in the same way, while it also shows the students who learn differently from the neurotypical students.

Next, the third social problem is the difference between home support and learning environments, which is the third level of digital divide. Unequal parental time, energy and digital knowledge at home form the basis of this level (van Deursen & van Dijk, 2021). This problem affects those students whose parents work for long hours in physical work. So, Aiman must wait until his father comes back home from work late at night before he can borrow the shared smartphone. While wealthy families can hire private tuition, buy personal computers and provide suitable academic guidance, but parents who work for a long time often lack the time, energy and digital knowledge to assist with online homework for their child. This shows how a family shapes the amount of educational support that a child receives at home.

2.2 Education and Wider Social Structures

These three structures shape Aiman's daily school experience. First, his family's low income and his father's work as a construction worker limit the household to a single shared smartphone. Because the phone is for his father's employment, so due to the need to support the family, Aiman's studies were forced to step aside. Second, the infrastructure of the semi-rural places creates weak internet connections, which will make it difficult for students to complete online activities. Research shows that weak internet infrastructure in semi-rural areas frequently block poor students from completing online tasks (Md Yunus et al., 2021). Third, the management of the school runs a standard digital policy that assumes all students learn the same way, while it blames poor students for their personal situations.

2.3 Digital Divide, Educational Inequality & Inclusive Education

Comparing the differences between Aiman, Daniel and Siti, it shows that applying the same rule to different students will lead to unfair grades and results. It is because Daniel comes from a rich family, he has his own laptop, fast internet and helpful parents for his academic support, which helps him succeed easily in online schoolworks. Besides, Siti lives in an area with unstable internet, which forces her family need to travel to nearby towns to get a signal. While Aiman faces both issues, like severe financial limits and reading difficulties from dyslexia. Giving all three students the exact same task reflects educational equality in the society, which treats every learner in the same way no matter their background. However, treating students with different backgrounds in the exact same way only makes things harder for struggling students. Hence, true fairness in school needs equity, which means providing students different tools, extra support and different options according to their needs.

Aiman's dyslexia makes it difficult for him to complete online tasks. It is because dyslexia makes reading words and long texts difficult, but it does not mean a student is not smart or cannot speak well in class. When teachers give long and heavy word PDF files or presentation slides without audio support, Aiman cannot learn easily. For example, reading a long text on a small screen will force Aiman to spend a lot of time just trying to read every word instead of understanding the lesson. As a result, without supported tools like software that can have text-to-speech or change special fonts into simple fonts and suitable size, it will make reading easier, then Aiman will not waste all his energy on reading words instead of learning the lesson. It is

because text-to-speech software will improve reading comprehension and reduce reading stress for dyslexia students (Wood & Moxley, 2022).

Good differentiation, teacher support, accessible lesson files and assessment support are very important for inclusive education, but the school still lacks these. Good differentiation means teachers teach lessons in different ways, such as using or adding a video with written notes on the slides or board. Differentiated teaching using audio, video and visual tools helps diverse students learn much better (Palieraki & Koutrouba, 2021). Some teachers use accessible resources like audio recordings, videos and pictures, but the school has no standard policy requiring all digital materials to be accessible for students with learning difficulties. Because of this, the support Aiman gets depends on which teacher is teaching the subject. Also, because the school does not train teachers or provide helpful software, special needs students do not get enough help for all subjects. Furthermore, the school also lacks assessment support. Since Aiman is active and good at speaking during class discussions, so teachers should let him submit his schoolwork using voice recordings or oral presentation instead of forcing him to read and type long text online.

The online lesson fails to help students with special needs. The school treats dyslexia as an individual problem that Aiman must overcome by himself. On the other hand, the social model of disability shows that the school creates the problem by forcing students to use difficult to read text files and strict online lesson rules. Strict school rules and unsupportive learning environments create the real barrier to student learning, not the student's disability (Zaks, 2023). In the online meetings, some teachers say giving the same work is fair to everyone, but it is also

ignored that rich students already have better computers and support at home. By implementing the lesson rules without accessibility options, schools protect rich students while making struggling students look like their personal failures.

This unfair rule creates bad results on three different levels. On the individual level, Aiman will feel frustrated, it also will lose his confidence and he will stop caring about his grades, which makes him more likely to drop out. While on the school level, this rule widens the gap between rich and poor students, it fails to build digital skills for them and also brings arguments among teachers. Moreover, on the society level, ignoring poor and special needs students will keep their families poor for a long time and wastes the talents of students who could help the country become better in the future.

2.4 Proposed Interventions and Recommendations

To overcome these issues, the school should create the Universal Design for Learning (UDL) Policy. Applying UDL Policy in online classes helps teachers include all types of students (Ismailov & Chiu, 2022). In this policy, teachers must use different materials in the lesson, like combining the short text with audio voice notes and pictures or diagrams. Besides, teachers must also allow flexible time for schoolworks submissions, letting Aiman submit voice recordings or oral explanations instead of writing long texts. According to Ministry of Education guidelines, all mainstream schools must give equal learning opportunities to special needs students (Kementerian Pendidikan Malaysia, 2021). Also, adding audio support with text reduces reading stress and improves the understanding for dyslexia students (Rao et al., 2021).

Second, the school should apply a Device Loan and Offline Learning Strategy. In this strategy, the school will lend laptops or tablets to low income families like Aiman, while also providing downloadable offline lessons that do not require live internet at home. This strategy is supported by the Malaysian Ministry of Education's Digital Education Policy (Dasar Pendidikan Digital), which requires equal internet and devices access for poor students. The Malaysian Ministry of Education mentioned that equal access to devices and digital tools for disadvantaged students are needed (Kementerian Pendidikan Malaysia, 2023). Research also shows that giving school devices and offline lessons close the digital divide for poor families without costing parents extra money.

3.0 Conclusion and Declaration of AI Use

In conclusion, this report shows that online learning fails to deliver lessons when schools ignore student's backgrounds. Aiman's case highlighted three levels of the digital divide, which are lack of devices and internet, heavy text lesson teaching without audio or visual support and unequal home support. The main findings prove that treating every student in the same way will lead to educational inequality. Strict school rules create the real barrier to learning rather than a student's personal impairment (Zaks, 2023).

Therefore, to solve these problems, the school must implement two realistic strategies. First, the Universal Design for Learning (UDL) Policy provides flexible teaching methods and schoolwork submissions options, which supports the Malaysian Zero Reject Policy (Kementerian Pendidikan Malaysia, 2021). Moreover, the Device Loan and Offline Learning Strategy provides laptops and downloadable offline lessons to ensure fair learning opportunities and digital access for low income families (Kementerian Pendidikan Malaysia, 2023). Together with these, these solutions will help to turn digital inequality from a barrier into an equal learning opportunities for different needs of students.

Declaration of AI Use

AI tools were used in brainstorming and preparing this report to support the organization of the main ideas, improve sentence structure and check grammar. I reviewed and edited in my own language and took responsibility for the final content of the report.

Reference

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QUEST INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES
BACHELOR OF SPECIAL NEEDS EDUCATION (HONS)
BSN1083 SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION
JULY 2026
FINAL ASSESSMENT RUBRIC: WRITTEN REPORT

NAME	**CAROLINE FAM ZHI XIN**
MATRIC NO	**QIU-202507-008503**

Grading Criteria	Superior - 5	Above Average - 4	Average - 3	Below Average - 2	Not meeting standard – 1	Total Marks
Introduction and Understanding of the Social Problem **(10 marks)**	Provides a clear, well-developed introduction to Sociology of Education and digital inequality. Clearly identifies the main social problems in the case and establishes the purpose and context of the analysis	Provides a clear introduction and identifies the main social problems with good explanation.	Provides a basic introduction and identifies relevant problems, but explanation lacks depth.	Introduction and identification of social problems are limited or unclear	Introduction is incomplete and demonstrates little understanding of the social problem.	X 2
Analysis of Education, Social	Provides a critical and insightful analysis of how wider social	Provides good analysis of social structures and educational inequality	Provides adequate analysis but connections between education,	Provides mainly descriptive discussion with weak connections	Provides little or no meaningful analysis of education, social	X 6

Structures and Inequality (30 marks)	structures, digital inequality, equality/equity and socioeconomic factors influence the educational experiences of the students. Clearly connects individual experiences to wider society	with clear connections to the case	social structures and inequality are somewhat limited.	to wider social structures.	structures or inequality.	
Disability, Inclusive Education, Technology and Power **(30 marks)**	Critically analyses the relationship between disability, accessibility, inclusive education, technology, school policy and power. Demonstrates strong understanding of how institutional practices can create or reduce inequality.	Provides good analysis of disability, inclusion, technology and policy with relevant connections to the case.	Demonstrates basic understanding but analysis is mainly descriptive.	Provides limited discussion of disability, inclusion, technology or policy.	Fails to demonstrate understanding of the relationship between these issues.	X 6
Consequences and Recommendations **(10 marks)**	Clearly analyses consequences at the individual, institutional and societal levels and proposes two highly relevant, realistic and evidence-based strategies that promote equity and inclusion.	Analyses the consequences at the three levels and provides two appropriate recommendations supported by evidence.	Discusses consequences and provides recommendations, but analysis or supporting evidence is limited.	Provides limited discussion of consequences and/or recommendations are weak or insufficiently supported.	Fails to adequately discuss consequences or provide appropriate recommendations.	X 2

Conclusion **(10 marks)**	Provides a strong conclusion that synthesises the analysis.	Provides a clear conclusion	Provides an adequate conclusion	Poor conclusion	Conclusion is absent or inadequate.	X2
Citations and References **(10 marks)**	All sources are accurately cited in-text and listed in the reference section; follows the required referencing style consistently; no errors.	Most sources are correctly cited and referenced; minor errors in formatting or style.	Some sources cited correctly; several formatting or style errors; missing a few references.	Few sources correctly cited; many errors or inconsistencies; references incomplete.	Sources mostly missing or incorrectly cited; major errors; does not follow referencing style.	X 2
Total						/ 100 / 20

[APPENDIX 3]

FACULTY OF SOCIAL SCIENCES
BACHELOR OF SPECIAL NEEDS EDUCATION (HONS)
BSN1083 SOCIOLOGY OF EDUCATION
JULY 2026
ORAL PRESENTATION RUBRIC –
FINAL ASSESSMENT

NAME		MATRIC NO
Presenter	**CAROLINE FAM ZHI XIN**	**QIU-202507-008503**

Criteria	Superior	Above Average	Average	Below Average	Inferior	Mark Presenter 1
	4	3	2	1	0	
1. Nonverbal Skills (10 marks) ● Good eye contact with entire audience; regularly scans the room. ● Natural hand gestures, no distracting mannerisms, stands up straight. ● Confident speaker.						x 2.5 =
2. Verbal Skills (10 marks) ● Demonstrates a strong positive attitude throughout the presentation.						x 2.5 =

● Uses voice effectively to emphasize points. ● Minimal vocalized pauses (er, umm, ahh, etc.) ● Rarely mispronounces words/terms. ● Delivery rate is appropriate for understanding and attention.						
3. Organization (20 marks) ● Effective opening which states what the presentation will cover. ● Presentation is well-organized. ● Excellent transitions throughout which are seamless. ● Presentation matches announced purpose and meets all objectives.						x 5 =
4. Content (30 marks) ● Covers all important/ main content in the report ● Supports points with good explanations, examples and illustrations. ● Provides balanced and in-depth coverage across all different components. ● Summarizes with valid conclusions, supported by facts/data.						x 7.5 =

5. Use of Media (10 marks) ● Slides / media for the presentation are visually attractive, readable and supportive of the content. ● Refers to slides / note cards occasionally or not at all.						x 2.5 =
6. Q & A (20 marks) i. Answers questions appropriately and correctly, and with confidence. ii. Provides accurate, relevant responses with clear and well-reasoned justification.						x 5 =
					TOTAL MARKS:	**/100** **/20**

** Feel free to separate the presenter's score on one sheet.*